South African Texas Transfers

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South African Texas Transfers are transfer bids in response to a 1NT opening. They are a variation of Texas Transfers, and use the club and diamond suits (instead of diamonds and hearts) to transfer to the majors.

Bid	Meaning
4♣	At least 6 hearts and game values, requiring partner to rebid 4♥.
4♦	At least 6 spades and game values, requiring partner to rebid 4♠.

South African Texas is less popular than Texas Transfers. The minor benefit of South African Texas is that it is theoretically easier to remember 4♦ as a transfer bid rather than 4♥. The drawback to South African Texas is the loss of Gerber 4♣.

It can also be noted that South African Texas offers the ability to show game-forcing spade hands in three ways:

- Via a 2♥ Jacoby Transfer followed by a 4♠ rebid, hinting at slam.
- Via a 4♦ transfer.
- Via a direct 4♠ bid.

In interference, South African Texas is only on if the interference is lower than 3♦.

Origins

South African Texas is attributed to Max Sapire of South Africa, a prominent player in the 1960s and 1970s. According to "The Encyclopedia of Bridge", it is also credited as the original form of Texas Transfers invented by American player David Carter.

See also

- Four-Suit Transfers
  Artificial transfers into all four suits.
- Jacoby Transfers
  Major suit transfers at the 2-level.
- Minor Suit Transfers
  Transfers into clubs or diamonds, used after partner opens 1NT.
- Texas Transfers
  Major suit transfers at the 4-level.